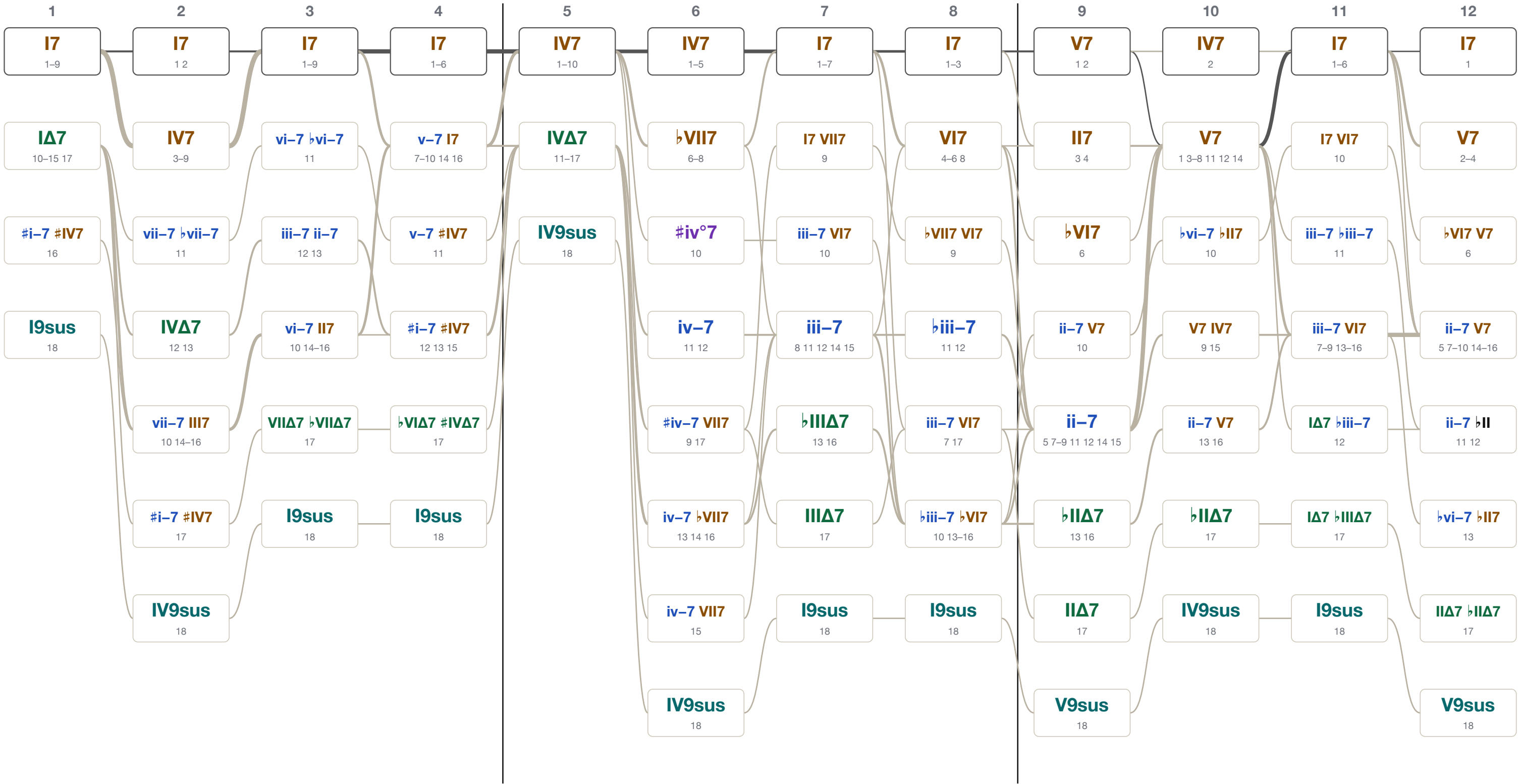


The 12-bar blues map

every chord option in 18 forms, simplest first

Any key: I is the key chord

Bars 1–4 I, or something standing in for it	I7 11–9 IΔ7 10–15 17 #i–7 #IV7 16 I9sus 18	I7 1 2 IV7 3–9 vii–7 ♭vii–7 11 IVΔ7 12 13 vii–7 III7 10 14–16 #i–7 #IV7 17 IV9sus 18	I7 1–9 vi–7 ♭vi–7 11 iii–7 ii–7 12 13 vi–7 II7 10 14–16 VIIΔ7 ♭VIIΔ7 17 I9sus 18	I7 1–6 v–7 I7 7–10 14 16 v–7 #IV7 11 #i–7 #IV7 12 13 15 ♭VIIΔ7 #IVΔ7 17 I9sus 18
	IV7 1–10 IVΔ7 11–17 IV9sus 18	IV7 1–5 ♭VII7 6–8 #iv°7 10 iv–7 11 12 #iv–7 VII7 9 17 iv–7 ♭VII7 13 14 16 iv–7 VII7 15 IV9sus 18	I7 1–7 I7 VII7 9 iii–7 VI7 10 iii–7 8 11 12 14 15 ♭IIIAΔ7 13 16 IIIAΔ7 17 I9sus 18	I7 1–3 VI7 4–6 8 ♭VII7 VI7 9 ♭iii–7 11 12 iii–7 VI7 7 17 ♭iii–7 ♭VI7 10 13–16 I9sus 18
	V7 1 2 II7 3 4 ♭VI7 6 ii–7 V7 10 ii–7 5 7–9 11 12 14 15 ♭IIAΔ7 13 16 IIAΔ7 17 V9sus 18	IV7 2 V7 1 3–8 11 12 14 ♭vi–7 ♭II7 10 V7 IV7 9 15 ii–7 V7 13 16 ♭IIAΔ7 17 IV9sus 18	I7 1–6 I7 VI7 10 iii–7 ♭iii–7 11 iii–7 VI7 7–9 13–16 IΔ7 ♭iii–7 12 IΔ7 ♭IIIAΔ7 17 I9sus 18	I7 1 V7 2–4 ♭VI7 V7 6 ii–7 V7 5 7–10 14–16 ii–7 ♭II 11 12 ♭vi–7 ♭II7 13 IIAΔ7 ♭IIAΔ7 17 V9sus 18



The 18 forms

bold: changed from the row above

Any key: I is the key chord

Form	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
1 Basic blues	I7	I7	I7	I7	IV7	IV7	I7	I7	V7	V7	I7	I7
2 V–IV cadence	I7	I7	I7	I7	IV7	IV7	I7	I7	V7	IV7	I7	V7
3 Quick four + II7	I7	IV7	I7	I7	IV7	IV7	I7	I7	II7	V7	I7	V7
4 VI7–II7–V7 chain	I7	IV7	I7	I7	IV7	IV7	I7	VI7	II7	V7	I7	V7
5 Diatonic ii–V	I7	IV7	I7	I7	IV7	IV7	I7	VI7	ii–7	V7	I7	ii–7 V7
6 IV of IV + tritone subs	I7	IV7	I7	I7	IV7	bVII7	I7	VI7	bVI7	V7	I7	bVI7 V7
7 ii–V into IV; iii–VI–ii–V	I7	IV7	I7	v–7 I7	IV7	bVII7	I7	iii–7 VI7	ii–7	V7	iii–7 VI7	ii–7 V7
8 iii– in bar 7	I7	IV7	I7	v–7 I7	IV7	bVII7	iii–7	VI7	ii–7	V7	iii–7 VI7	ii–7 V7
9 Chromatic dominants	I7	IV7	I7	v–7 I7	IV7	#iv–7 VII7	I7 VII7	bVII7 VI7	ii–7	V7 IV7	iii–7 VI7	ii–7 V7
10 Bird blues	IΔ7	vii–7 III7	vi–7 II7	v–7 I7	IV7	#iv°7	iii–7 VI7	biii–7 bVI7	ii–7 V7	bvi–7 bII7	I7 VI7	ii–7 V7
11 Chromatic minor sevenths	IΔ7	vii–7 bvii–7	vi–7 bvi–7	v–7 #IV7	IVΔ7	iv–7	iii–7	biii–7	ii–7	V7	iii–7 biii–7	ii–7 bII
12 Major sevenths + chromatic minors	IΔ7	IVΔ7	iii–7 ii–7	#i–7 #IV7	IVΔ7	iv–7	iii–7	biii–7	ii–7	V7	IΔ7 biii–7	ii–7 bII
13 ii–Vs to bIII and bII	IΔ7	IVΔ7	iii–7 ii–7	#i–7 #IV7	IVΔ7	iv–7 bVII7	bIIIAΔ7	biii–7 bVI7	bIIAΔ7	ii–7 V7	iii–7 VI7	bvi–7 bII7
14 Blues for Alice style	IΔ7	vii–7 III7	vi–7 II7	v–7 I7	IVΔ7	iv–7 bVII7	iii–7	biii–7 bVI7	ii–7	V7	iii–7 VI7	ii–7 V7
15 Tritone-sub ii–V into IV	IΔ7	vii–7 III7	vi–7 II7	#i–7 #IV7	IVΔ7	iv–7 VII7	iii–7	biii–7 bVI7	ii–7	V7 IV7	iii–7 VI7	ii–7 V7
16 ii–V chain from bar 1	#i–7 #IV7	vii–7 III7	vi–7 II7	v–7 I7	IVΔ7	iv–7 bVII7	bIIIAΔ7	biii–7 bVI7	bIIAΔ7	ii–7 V7	iii–7 VI7	ii–7 V7
17 Major-seventh planing	IΔ7	#i–7 #IV7	VIIAΔ7 bVIIAΔ7	bVIAΔ7 #IVAΔ7	IVΔ7	#iv–7 VII7	IIIAΔ7	iii–7 VI7	IIAΔ7	bIIAΔ7	IΔ7 bIIIAΔ7	IIAΔ7 bIIAΔ7
18 Sus-chord blues	I9sus	IV9sus	I9sus	I9sus	IV9sus	IV9sus	I9sus	I9sus	V9sus	IV9sus	I9sus	V9sus